

1978-1992 Cases of UAPs in Cyprus

Source: The Cyprus Society for the Study of Unexplained Aerial Phenomena. President and Founder, Dr. Andreas Achillides. In Achillides, Andreas. *The Universe, Life, and UFO*, 1992.

November 27, 1978

Location: Yeroskipou village, Paphos

Time: 3 AM

Local farmer N. Hadjimitsis was plowing his field with a tractor, when he observed a bright object hovering above a sycamore tree, approximately 100 meters away. The tractor engine stopped running, and he dismounted to take a better look. He saw a disk-shaped object with illuminated portholes. The object hovered for a few minutes before disappearing soundlessly at very high speed towards the east.

December 16, 1978

Location: Timi village, Paphos

Time: Midnight

Local farmer E. Soloyiannis observed a bright object hovering a few meters over his animal barn. The object emitted an orange light for ten minutes and then disappeared without any sound in the direction of the Mediterranean Sea. The farmer reported burn signs on one goat, an injured goat, a missing herd dog, and reduced milk production (for both goat and sheep) in the subsequent days. Measurements taken by Dr. Achillides using a Geiger counter detected no spikes in radiation levels.

December 20, 1978

Location: Yeroskipou village, Paphos

Time: 5 AM

G. Ioannou, a merchant, was driving his car from Paphos to Limassol when he observed an elongated object, the size of a large car, hovering in the sky at an altitude of 500 meters above the ground. The object was very bright and emitted a strong orange light. His wife who travelled

with him also saw the object. The object accompanied them to Aphrodite's Rock (a distance of 21 km) before disappearing in the direction of the east, towards the British Bases at Akrotiri.

March 7, 1989

Location: Cyprus Broadcasting Corporation, Nicosia

Time: Midnight

Kostas Leonidou, the night guard on duty at Cyprus Broadcasting Corporation (CyBC), witnessed a bright object slowly approaching the station at an altitude of 50 meters above the ground. The object measured approximately seven feet long, did not resemble an airplane or helicopter, and featured five light beams that emitted a pale red light. He took cover behind the guard post and observed as the object "cruised" soundlessly across the night sky in a northern direction. The event lasted about one minute and during that time the witness felt no fear but a sense of calm. Other witnesses reported the same sighting occurring at the same time.

January 24, 1992

Location: Concurrent sightings of the same phenomenon throughout Cyprus

Time: Approximately midnight (23:50)

A number of credible witnesses in various locations in Cyprus observed a round, brightly illuminated flying object with a prominent tail. Specifically:

The well-known musician and journalist Phivos Theocharides was driving home to the village of Malounta when he saw a light rising from the ground. He attributed it to exercises at the military base nearby, but then saw a huge object, measuring 100 x 40 meters, ascending and emitting a light buzzing sound. He pulled over and looking through the windshield glass, he saw the object hovering right above his car. He noticed how the bottom surface brilliantly reflected the street below like a mirror. At that moment, he felt his car lifted from the ground and thrown into the neighboring field separated from the road by a deep ditch. He panicked and jumped out of the car. The object gained height and accelerated in the direction of the south, towards Limassol. The event lasted one minute.

Army officer Dimitri Theodorou, his wife, and their ten year-old daughter were driving home to the village of Malounta. They saw an object in the sky and, thinking it was a comet, they stopped the car and got out to take a better look. They saw a red, round object, twice the size of the full Moon, with a tail measuring several feet long, and moving alongside it, an array of red sparks. The event lasted about a minute before the object made an elliptical turn and disappeared in the direction of the south, towards Limassol.

Ms. Marousa, a Cyprus Broadcasting Corporation journalist, was driving home to the Akropolis suburb of Nicosia accompanied by her sister, Eugenia, when her sister first witnessed a bright object in the sky. They saw a round object emitting bright white light from the front side, and a tail that trailed behind it a myriad sparks of light. The object moved soundlessly, resembling a riverboat cruising quietly, creating “an atmosphere of serenity in the moonless night”.

Four credible witnesses, all university graduates, witnessed a brightly lit round sphere accompanied by several smaller objects in the sky over the Makedonitissa area of Nicosia. The objects left behind a tail of star-like lights. A few seconds later, the smaller lights dissipated and the larger mass with the bright tail moved slowly in a western direction, towards the Troodos mountain range. The whole event lasted a few minutes but it was “extraordinary”.

Four credible witnesses saw a similar object headed in a southern direction, towards Limassol.

Twenty witnesses saw a similar object fly over the Panthea suburb of Limassol.

Mr. and Mrs. Symillides, both bank employees, saw a similar object in the sky above the village of Kolossi. Mr. Simillides reported a huge, bright, crescent-shaped object with a shiny tail approximately ten feet long. The tail emitted colorful translucent light that resembled a high beam light in the fog. The event lasted three to five minutes during which the witness didn’t feel fear but “a sense of calmness”. He regretted not having his camera with him to record this “remarkable” occurrence.

Eight members of the Loftis Bar Darts Team were standing at the check-point entrance of the British Bases at Akrotiti, when the team leader, Nikos Georgiou, a civil engineer, saw a bright object in the sky moving steadily in a north-south direction. The object resembled a red full Moon with a large sparkly tail. He alerted the military guard who was busy checking their identification papers for entrance to the base. The guard immediately notified his superiors.

Fifty additional witnesses reported the same sighting in similar detail and clarity. No photographs were taken.

Interestingly, the object was not detected by the Cyprus National Guard Radar at Troodos (elevation 1,952 m., 6,400 ft.). The radar facility experienced technical problems that night.

August 18, 1992

Location: Concurrent sightings of the same phenomenon in various locations throughout Cyprus

Time: Approximately midnight

The object was witnessed by a number of credible witnesses in various locations in Cyprus. Specifically:

Mr. G.Z, a high school professor on family vacation at Coral Bay, in Paphos, was sitting on his balcony when he saw a small dot illuminating the night sky. The dot was travelling at a very high speed, at a high altitude, in the direction of west-northwest. The dot grew larger and more prominent as it neared, following a curved trajectory and producing a bright, cone-shaped end. The dot grew into a sphere and then into a very bright ball of light that turned the night into day. The light was so bright that it blinded the witness. A second later, it disappeared. The entire event lasted three seconds and it was soundless.

Mr. P.P, an employee of the Cyprus Meteorology Department stationed at Paphos, witnessed an object flying inland from the direction of the Mediterranean Sea and headed northwest. The witness was blinded by the intensity of the light emitted by the object, but afterwards he noticed a contrail similar to that of an airplane. With the help of meteorological equipment, he estimated the length of the contrail to be 15-20 km long at an altitude of 7-8 km. He alerted the Military Base at Akrotiri, and was told that they were observing the phenomenon.

Mr. A.P., a walky-talky salesman, was camping at Lady's Mile beach, in Limassol, with his family and friends when he saw a bright cigar-shaped object travelling north from the direction of the port of Limassol. The object emitted bright light that illuminated the entire area and left behind a plume of white smoke on a straight line path. The smoke was visible for about ten minutes before it dissolved. Shortly after, a patrol car from the British Base at Akrotiri arrived, and the head officer made inquiries about the event.

Mr. K.L., a known artist, was at Moniatis village with seven friends when he saw a fiery mass in the sky moving from the Akrotiri peninsula towards the Troodos Mountains. The object was of a fiery red color with blue strikes. The object's light intensity increased and lasted a few seconds before it extinguished and released a dark cloud. A few minutes later, the witness felt a gust of wind blowing through the tree leaves.

Mr. P.D. from the village of Erimi witnessed a bright orange line in the sky followed by an "explosion". The light changed from orange to bright blue and was visible for 3-4 seconds before it disappeared.

Mrs. Eleni from the village of Lythrodontas and other members of the Old Calendar Orthodox Church were observing an all-night vigil when a bright blue light appeared and illuminated the church. Church members witnessed an apparition in the shape of golden cross. Some members recall a similar event that allegedly took place 60 years ago.

Mrs. L.F. from the Akropolis suburb of Nicosia witnessed a bright sphere in the sky. The sphere exploded, emitting an orange-yellow light and a slight sound. When the light dispersed, it left behind a trail of smoke several meters long.

One hundred additional witnesses reported the same sighting in similar detail and clarity.